

Define me

The Jargon File defines a hacker as "A person who enjoys exploring the details of programmable systems and how to stretch their capabilities, as opposed to most users, who prefer to learn only the minimum necessary"

The generation gap

Levy identifies different generations of hackers with first generation hackers being the software hackers, the second generation hackers being hardware hackers and third generation hackers being game hackers

that such a situation does not happen for real when the damage done would be much more catastrophic.

2 \\\| -173B0>< 73\$71\|9

White Box testing is performed with full knowledge of, and perhaps even access to the internals of the system. Since White Box testing is based on knowledge that we already have, some of its aspects can be automated. As such it is much simpler to accomplish than Black Box testing.

It can evaluate the security of the system in case of an attack by people who have knowledge of the system, its configuration and structure, and possibly even some passwords. It is a simulation of an attack which could be an inside job, or in case of information being leaked about the system.

| -14(|<3r 37|-1(\$

Steven Levy lays down some guidelines for hacker ethics in his book "Hackers: Heroes of the Computer Revolution". Anyone who calls themselves a hacker usually adheres and believes in these principles.

- Access to computers—and anything which might teach you something about the way the world works—should be unlimited and total. Always yield to the Hands-On Imperative!

Limited access implies that there is only a limited amount that you stand to learn. Copying other peoples work might be regarded as wrong, but for faster and better progress, copying means that you have more time to innovate. You can put your effort into improving things rather than just coming to terms with them.

- All information should be free. By charging for or otherwise restricting information, the number of people who can be exposed to it is reduced. People with need for information are not necessarily the ones who can afford it.

Information is what innovations and inventions are

THE GRASS IS GREENER ON THE GREYER SIDE

With white hats and back hats, white boxes and black boxes, you might get the wrong impression about how simple this world is. As always, nothing is merely black and white, it is the grey area in between which is the most people's abode. Grey Hat Hackers: They are more representative of normal people with faltering consciences. People who operate legally for the most part but aren't immune to the occasion thrill that can only come from committing a crime. Grey Box Testing: By using a limited knowledge of a system, and its internals you can perform Grey Box Testing. These tests are performed like Black Box tests, by merely fiddling around with the external access points of the system, while using information that is not available during black box testing.

built upon, farther the reaches of information the greater the good it can do, and the more people it will inspire.

One of the biggest reasons the internet is popular is that it is a free resource of information. Companies are beginning to learn this the hard way, as we can see with Microsoft's recent abandonment of their Encarta Encyclopedia.

- *Mistrust authority—promote decentralization.*

Centralizing is akin to putting all your eggs into one basket. By making everything dependent on a single authority you become slave to it. We have seen over time that any trust placed in authority is trust misplaced.

Corporations such as the RIAA damage the consumers and artists by punishing fans on the artists' behalf while the artist watched helplessly in disgust. In a decentralized system each person has control over their own work, and how much you plan to share and with whom is entirely up to you.

- *Hackers should be judged by their hacking, not criteria such as degrees, age, race, or position.*

Let your code do the talking! Your shiny degree from MIT is pretty much worthless if you need help from a cross referenced instruction manual in order to butter your toast.

Age, race, sex, and position are non-factors when the only thing of value is the work that you do. It is only the work that you do which lives on after you. Ignoring someone's experience and work based on any of these factors is sure to act as a hurdle to progress. Everyone is capable of contributing something, and the only measure of the contribution should be the contribution itself.

- *You can create art and beauty on a computer.*

Art and beauty are subjective considerations, not limited to a medium. You don't need a canvas and paint to bring you imagination to life. Computers can give you many, many more dimensions to play with and express yourself. Your art can transcend the mere three dimensions of physical art. Software code is a great source of beauty to those who understand it's intricacies. Creating code that runs faster, or uses less memory, or fewer steps, is an art in itself.

- *Computers can change your life for the better.*

Computers are something that can greatly increase the grasp a person has on the workings of the world. Computers literally put all the information within the reach of your fingertips. Anything is possible if only you can imagine it (and program it).

We no longer need to deal with static

pieces of paper which contain information that is outdated minutes after it is published. You can now be an active part bringing people what they need to know. With initiatives like Wikipedia, you can have the knowledge of the entire world at your fingertips and not just the words of a select few whose voice reaches farther than others'.

(0)\|(LU510\|

Hacking is no longer the realm of a hobby or a crime, curiosity should never be considered an ill trait. It is in out very nature to discover the workings of the things surrounding us and the best thing is, you can now get paid for it!

Hacking is not everyone's cup of tea, but for the few people who have what it takes it is no longer something they need to suppress into a hobby. More and more people are putting their curiosity to better use with careers in professional hackers, the ethics are part of the job if nothing else.

We have always paid homage to the brave people who have "hacked" the laws of this world and brought us the modern day conveniences that we can no longer imagine living without. Computer hackers are merely people who test the laws of computing and push the limits of what they can do. In a way though we are all hackers. Every day we test the working of the things around us whether we know how they work or not and no matter which hat you chose to wear, there is no greater joy in discovering the limits and pushing past them. 

